

# Topology

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Throughout this outline,  $S$  is a set of points in which there is determined a collection of subsets called *neighborhoods*, satisfying the following two axioms:

**Axiom 1:** Each point of  $S$  is contained in a neighborhood.

**Axiom 2:** If  $A$  is a neighborhood of a point  $p$ , and  $B$  is a neighborhood of  $p$ , then there exists a neighborhood  $C$  of  $p$  such that  $A \cap B$  contains  $C$ .

**Definition 3:**  $S$  is called a *topological space* (or simply a *space*).

**Definition 4:**  $A$  is a *neighborhood* of  $p$  if  $A$  is a neighborhood and  $p \in A$ .

**Definition 5:** A point  $p$  is an *interior point* of a set  $H$  if there exists a neighborhood  $A$  of  $p$  such that  $A \subseteq H$ .

**Definition 6:** A point set  $H$  is *open* if every point of  $H$  is an interior point.

**Proposition 7:** Neighborhoods are open.

**Proposition 8:** The union of any collection of open sets is open.

**Proposition 9:** The intersection of two open sets is open.

**Proposition 10:**  $S$  is open.

**Definition 11:** A subset  $H$  of  $S$  is *closed* if  $S - H$  is open.

**Proposition 12:** The union of two closed sets is closed.

**Proposition 13:** The intersection of two closed sets is closed.

**Question 14:** Do Propositions 3, 5, and 6 extend to arbitrary collections?

**Definition 15:** A point  $p$  is a *limit point* of  $H$  if every open set containing  $p$  contains a point of  $H$  distinct from  $p$ .

**Proposition 16:** A point set is closed if and only if it contains each limit point of the set.

**Proposition 17:**  $S$  is closed.

**Proposition 18:** The empty set is both open and closed.

**Proposition 19:** A point  $p$  is a limit point of  $H$  if and only if each neighborhood of  $p$  contains a point of  $H$  distinct from  $p$ .

**Definition 20:** The *closure*  $\overline{H}$  of a point set  $H$ , is the union of  $H$  and the set of all limit points of  $H$ .

**Proposition 21:**  $\overline{H}$  is the intersection of all closed supersets of  $H$ .

**Corollary 21.1:**  $\overline{H}$  is closed.

**Definition 22:** The *interior* ( $\text{Int } H$ ) of a point set  $H$  is the set of interior points of  $H$ .

**Proposition 23:**  $\text{Int } H$  is the union of all open subsets of  $H$ .

**Definition 24:** The *boundary* ( $\text{Bd } H$ ) of  $H$  is  $\overline{H} - \text{Int } H$ .

**Proposition 25:**  $\text{Bd } H = \overline{H} \cap \overline{S - H}$

**Proposition 26:**  $\text{Bd } H$  is empty if and only if  $H$  is both open and closed.

**Definition 27:** Two non-empty point sets  $A$  and  $B$  are *separated* if  $A \cap \overline{B} = B \cap \overline{A} = \emptyset$ .

**Definition 28:** A point set is *connected* if it is not the union of two separated sets.

**Proposition 29:** The unit interval  $[0, 1]$  (with the standard topology) is connected. (Assume every nonempty subset of  $[0, 1]$  has a least upper bound.)

**Proposition 30:**  $S$  is not connected if and only if there exists a nonempty proper subset  $H$  of  $S$  such that  $\text{Bd } H = \emptyset$ .

**Proposition 31:** If  $H$  is connected, then so is  $H \cup H'$  where  $H'$  is in  $\overline{H} - H$ .

**Proposition 32:** If each of  $H$  and  $K$  is connected and  $H \cap K \neq \emptyset$ , then  $H \cup K$  and  $H \cap K$  are connected.

**Definition 33:** A collection  $G$  of point sets is *coherent* if  $G$  is not the union of two nonempty subcollections  $E$  and  $F$  such that  $E^* \cap F^* = \emptyset$ . ( $E^* = \cup\{H : H \in E\}$ )

**Proposition 34:** If  $G$  is a coherent collection of connected sets, then  $G^*$  is connected.

**Proposition 35:** If  $C$  is a connected set and  $G$  is a collection of connected sets no member of which is separated from  $C$ , then  $C \cup G^*$  is connected.

**Corollary 35.1:** If  $C$  is connected and  $G$  is a collection of connected sets such that  $C \cap H \neq \emptyset$  for each element  $H$  of  $G$ , then  $C \cup G^*$  is connected.

**Corollary 35.2:**  $R^n$  (Euclidean  $n$ -space) is connected.

**Definition 36:** A collection  $G$  of open sets is an *open covering* of a set  $H$  if  $H$  is a subset of  $G^*$ .

**Definition 37:** A set  $H$  is *bicompact* if each open covering of  $H$  has a finite subcovering.

**Proposition 38:** The unit interval  $[0, 1]$  (with the standard topology) is bi-compact.

**Proposition 39:** A closed subset of a bicomact space is bicomact. The union of a finite family of bicomact subsets of a space is bicomact.

**Corollary 39.1:** The bicomact subsets of  $R^1$  are precisely the closed sets with finite diameters.

**Definition 40:** A family of sets has the *finite intersection property* (f.i.p) provided each of its finite subfamilies has nonempty intersection.

**Proposition 41:** A space is bicomact if and only if each family of closed sets having the f.i.p. has nonempty intersection.

**Proposition 42:** A subset of  $R^n$  is bicomact if and only if it is closed and has finite diameter.

**Definition 43:** A topological space is *regular* if for each point  $p$  and each neighborhood  $N$  of  $p$ , there exists a neighborhood  $M$  of  $p$  such that  $\overline{M}$  is a subset of  $N$ .

**Proposition 44:**  $S$  is regular if and only if for each point  $p$  and each closed set  $H$  not containing  $p$ , there exist open sets  $V$  and  $W$  such that  $H \subset V \subset S - W \subset S - \{p\}$ .

**Definition 45:** A point set  $K$  is *nowhere dense* if  $\overline{K}$  does not contain a non-empty open set.

**Proposition 46:** No bicomact regular space is the union of countably many nowhere dense sets.

**Definition 47:**  $S$  is a *Hausdorff space* if for each pair  $x, y$  of distinct points of  $S$ , there exist disjoint open sets  $X$  and  $Y$  such that  $x$  belongs to  $X$  and  $y$  belongs to  $Y$ .

**Proposition 48:** In a Hausdorff space, a set is bicomact if and only if it is closed.

**Proposition 49:** A space is Hausdorff if and only if it is regular.

**Definition 50:**  $S$  is *normal* if for each pair  $E, F$  of closed disjoint sets, there exist open sets  $V$  and  $W$  such that  $E \subset V \subset S - W \subset S - F$ .

**Proposition 51:** Every bicomact Hausdorff space is regular.

**Proposition 52:** Every regular bicomact space is normal.

**Definition 53:** A space is *Lindelof* if each open covering of the space has a countable subcovering.

**Proposition 54:** Every Lindelof space is normal.

**Definition 55:** A *component* of a point set  $X$  is a connected subset of  $X$  that is not a proper subset of a connected subset of  $X$ .

**Proposition 56:** Each point of a set  $H$  belongs to one and only one component of  $H$ .

**Proposition 57:** Is each component of an open set open?

**Definition 58:** The  $p$ -component of a set  $X$  is the component of  $X$  that contains  $p$ .

**Proposition 59:** The  $p$ -component of a point set  $X$  is the union of all connected subsets of  $X$  that contain  $p$ .

**Proposition 60:** If  $H$  and  $K$  are connected sets,  $K \subset H$ , and  $H - K = A \cup B$  where  $A, B$  are separated sets, then  $A \cup K$  is connected.

**Question 61:** Is  $K \cup C$  connected when  $C$  is a component of  $H - K$ ?

**Definition 62:** A *continuum* is a bicomact connected Hausdorff space.

**Proposition 63:** Every nondegenerate continuum is uncountable.

**Proposition 64:** Every nondegenerate connected regular Hausdorff space is uncountable.

**Question 65:** Does there exist a nondegenerate countable connected Hausdorff space?

**Proposition 66:** No continuum is the union of a countable ( $> 1$ ) family of nonempty disjoint closed sets.

**Proposition 67:** Suppose  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct points of a bicomact Hausdorff space  $M$ , and suppose  $\{H_a : a \in A\}$  is an indexed collection of closed sets in  $M$  such that for each  $a \in A$ ,  $H_a \subset H_{a+1}$ , and  $H_a$  cannot be separated between  $p$  and  $q$ . Then  $\cap\{H_a : a \in A\}$  cannot be separated between  $p$  and  $q$ .

**Definition 68:** A continuum  $C$  is *irreducible between two disjoint sets* if  $C$  intersects each set and no proper subcontinuum of  $C$  intersects both sets.

**Proposition 69:** Each pair of points of a continuum lies in a subcontinuum irreducible between the two points.

**Definition 70:** A continuum  $H$  is *irreducible about a set*  $K$  if  $H$  contains  $K$  and no proper subcontinuum of  $H$  contains  $K$ .

**Proposition 71:** If  $K$  is any subset of a continuum  $C$ , then  $C$  contains a subcontinuum irreducible about  $K$ .

**Proposition 72:** Suppose  $X$  is a bicomact Hausdorff space, and  $p$  and  $q$  belong to different components of  $X$ . Then there exist separated sets  $H$  and  $K$  such that  $p$  belongs to  $H$ ,  $q$  belongs to  $K$ , and  $X = H \cup K$ .

**Question 73:** Does Proposition 72 hold when  $X$  is not bicomact?

**Proposition 74:** Suppose  $C$  is a continuum, and  $D$  is an open proper subset of  $C$  that contains a point  $p$ . Then  $\text{Bd } D$  contains a limit point of the  $p$ -component of  $D$ .

**Definition 75:** Suppose that  $\{X_n\}$  is a sequence of subsets of  $S$ . The set of all points  $x$  in  $S$  such that every open set containing  $x$  intersects all but a finite number of elements of  $\{X_n\}$  is called the *limit inferior* of  $\{X_n\}$  ( $\liminf X_n$ ). The set of all points  $y$  in  $S$  such that every open set containing  $y$  intersects infinitely many elements of  $\{X_n\}$  is called the *limit superior* of  $\{X_n\}$  ( $\limsup X_n$ ).

**Proposition 76:**  $\liminf X_n = \limsup X_n$ .

**Proposition 77:**  $\limsup X_n \neq \emptyset$ .

**Proposition 78:** If  $\liminf X_n \neq \emptyset$ , then  $\limsup X_n \neq \emptyset$ .

**Proposition 79:**  $\liminf X_n = \liminf \overline{X_n}$  and  $\limsup X_n = \limsup \overline{X_n}$ .

**Proposition 80:**  $\liminf X_n$  and  $\limsup X_n$  are both closed sets.

**Proposition 81:** If  $\{X_n\}$  is a sequence of connected sets in a continuum, and if  $\liminf X_n$  is not empty, then  $\limsup X_n$  is a continuum.

**Definition 82:** A function  $f$  of  $S$  into a space  $T$  is *continuous* provided that if  $p$  is a point of the closure of a subset  $X$  of  $S$ , then  $f(p)$  belongs to  $\overline{f[X]}$ . A continuous function is sometimes called a *map*.

**Proposition 83:** For real-valued functions of one real variable, this definition is equivalent to the standard  $\delta - \epsilon$  definition.

**Proposition 84:** Suppose  $f$  is a function of  $S$  into a space  $T$ . Then  $f$  is continuous if and only if for each open set  $G$  of  $T$ ,  $f^{-1}[G]$  is open in  $S$ .

**Question 85:** Does Proposition 84 hold when the word “open” is everywhere replaced by the word “closed”?

**Proposition 86:** Every continuous image of a connected space is connected.

**Proposition 87:** Every continuous image of a bicomact space is connected.

**Question 88:** Is the Lindelof property a continuous invariant?

**Proposition 89:** Every continuous image of a Hausdorff space is Hausdorff.

**Proposition 90:** The composition of two continuous functions is continuous.

**Proposition 91:** Suppose  $X$  is a bicomact space,  $Y$  is a Hausdorff space, and  $f$  is a one-to-one map of  $X$  onto  $Y$ . Then  $f^{-1}$  is continuous.

**Question 92:** Does Proposition 91 hold when  $X$  is not required to be bicomact?

**Proposition 93:** Every line interval  $[a, b]$  is an image of  $[0, 1]$  under a one-to-one map.

**Proposition 94:**  $S$  is a normal space if and only if for each pair  $A, B$  of disjoint closed subsets of  $S$ , there exists a map  $f$  of  $S$  into a line interval  $[a, b]$  such that  $f[A] = a$  and  $f[B] = b$ .

**Proposition 95:** For each positive integer  $n$ , let  $f_n$  be a map of  $S$  into the real line. Suppose there exists a convergent series of positive numbers  $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} M_n$ , such that for each point  $x$  of  $S$  and each  $n$ ,  $|f_n(x)| \leq M_n$ . Then for each point  $x$  of  $S$ , the infinite series  $\sum_{n=1}^{\infty} f_n(x)$  converges to a number  $f(x)$ , and the function  $f$  so defined is continuous.

**Definition 96:**  $S$  has the *continuous extension property* provided that for each map  $f$  of any closed subset  $H$  of  $S$  into an interval  $[a, b]$ , there exists a map  $f^*$  of  $S$  into  $[a, b]$  such that  $f^*(x) = f(x)$  for each point  $x$  of  $H$ .

**Proposition 97:**  $S$  is normal if and only if  $S$  has the continuous extension property.

**Proposition 98:** Suppose  $S$  is normal, and  $f$  is a map of a closed subset  $H$  of  $S$  into  $I^n$  (the Cartesian product of  $[0, 1]$  with itself  $n$  times). Then there exists an extension  $f^*$  of  $f$  to all of  $S$  (i.e.,  $f^* : S \rightarrow I^n$  and  $f^*(x) = f(x)$  for each point  $x$  of  $H$ ).

**Definition 99:** A collection  $C$  of open sets is a *base* for  $S$  if for each point  $p$  of  $S$ , and each open set  $U$  of  $S$  that contains  $p$ , there exists an element  $G$  of  $C$  such that  $p \in G \subset U$ .

**Definition 100:** The *Cartesian product* of the indexed collection of sets  $\{X_a : a \in A\}$  is the set of functions  $\times\{X_a : a \in A\} = \{f : A \rightarrow \cup\{X_a : a \in A\} \text{ and } f(a) \in X_a\}$ .

**Definition 101:** The  $a$ -th *projection map* is the function  $P_a : \times\{X_a : a \in A\} \rightarrow X_a$  such that  $P_a(x) = x_a$  for every point  $x$  of  $\times\{X_a : a \in A\}$ .

To define the standard topology given to the Cartesian product, called the *product topology*, we define the base.

**Definition 102:** A subset  $D$  of  $\times\{X_a : a \in A\}$  belongs to  $D$  if there is a finite subset  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$  of  $A$ , and open subsets  $D_1, D_2, \dots, D_n$  of  $X_{a_1}, X_{a_2}, \dots, X_{a_n}$ , respectively, such that  $D = \{x \in \times\{X_a : a \in A\} : x_{a_i} \text{ belongs to } D_i \text{ for } i = 1, 2, \dots, n\}$ . The collection forms a base for the product topology.

**Proposition 103:** If  $D$  is open in  $\times\{X_a : a \in A\}$ , then  $P_a[D]$  is open for every  $a$  belonging to  $A$ .

**Proposition 104:** A function  $f : S \rightarrow \times\{X_a : a \in A\}$  is continuous if and only if  $P_a f$  is continuous for each  $a$  belonging to  $A$ .

**Proposition 105:** The space  $\times\{X_a : a \in A\}$  is Hausdorff if and only if each  $X_a$  is a Hausdorff space.

**Proposition 106:** The product of two connected spaces is connected.

**Proposition 107:** The product of two normal spaces is normal.

**Proposition 108:** The product of two bicomact spaces is bicomact.

**Question 109:** Do Propositions 106, 107, and 108 extend to all Cartesian products?

**Definition 110:** A function  $d : S \times S \rightarrow [0, +\infty)$  is a *metric* for  $S$  if for every  $x, y$ , and  $z$  belonging to  $S$ :

1.  $d(x, y) = 0$  if and only if  $x = y$ ;
2.  $d(x, y) = d(y, x)$ ; and
3.  $d(x, y) + d(y, z) \geq d(x, z)$ .

**Definition 111:**  $S$  is a *metrizable space* (*metric space*) if there exists a metric  $d$  for  $S$  such that the collection  $\{N(x, r) : x \text{ belongs to } S \text{ and } r > 0\}$  is a base for the topology of  $S$  where  $N(x, r) = \{y : d(x, y) < r\}$ .

**Proposition 112:** The function  $d$  (defined above) is continuous.

**Definition 113:**  $S$  is *first countable* if for each point  $p$  of  $S$  there exists a countable collection  $C$  of open sets (each containing  $p$ ) such that every open set in  $S$  that contains  $p$  also contains an element of  $C$ .

**Proposition 114:**  $S$  is metrizable if and only if  $S$  is first countable.

**Definition 115:** A set is said to be of *type*  $G_\delta$  if it is the intersection of countably many open sets.

**Proposition 116:** Every closed subset of a metric space is of type  $G_\delta$ .

**Proposition 117:**  $S$  is *second countable* if  $S$  has a countable base.

**Proposition 118:** Every bicomact metric space is second countable.

**Definition 119:** A sequence  $\{X_n\}$  is a convergent sequence if  $\liminf X_n = \limsup X_n$ .

**Proposition 120:** If  $M$  is a bicomact metric space, then every sequence of subsets of  $M$  has a convergent subsequence.

**Definition 121:** A set  $D$  is a *dense subset* of a set  $E$  if  $D \subset E \subset \overline{D}$ .

**Definition 122:**  $S$  is a *separable* space if there exists a countable dense subset of  $S$ .



**Proposition 123:** A metric space is separable if and only if it is second countable.

**Proposition 124:** Proposition 123 holds for all spaces.

**Proposition 125:** Proposition 120 holds for separable metric spaces.

**Proposition 126:** A metric space  $M$  is bicomact if and only if every infinite subset of  $M$  has a limit point.

**Proposition 127:** Proposition 126 holds for all spaces.

**Proposition 128:** If every uncountable subset of a metric space  $M$  has a limit point, then every uncountable subset of  $M$  has a limit point.

**Proposition 129:** A metric space  $M$  is Lindelof if and only if every uncountable subset of  $M$  has a limit point.

**Proposition 130:** Proposition 129 holds for all spaces.

**Definition 131:** A sequence of points  $p_i$  in a metric space  $(M, d)$  is a *Cauchy sequence* if for each real number  $r > 0$ , there exists an integer  $N$  such that  $m, n > N$  implies  $d(p_m, p_n) < r$ . The metric space  $(M, d)$  is *complete* if each Cauchy sequence in  $M$  has a limit point in  $M$ .

**Definition 132:** A *homeomorphism* is a one-to-one map whose inverse is continuous.

**Proposition 133:** Suppose  $(M_1, d_1)$  and  $(M_2, d_2)$  are metric spaces, and there exists a homeomorphism of  $M_1$  onto  $M_2$  (i.e.,  $M_1$  and  $M_2$  are homeomorphic). Then  $(M_2, d_2)$  is complete if  $(M_1, d_1)$  is complete.

**Proposition 134:** Every closed subspace of a complete metric space is a complete metric space (with respect to the restricted metric).

**Proposition 135:** Suppose  $D$  is a dense type  $G_\delta$  subset of a complete metric space  $(M, d)$ . Then  $D$  is not the union of countably many nowhere-dense subsets of  $M$ .

**Question 136:** Is  $D$  in Proposition 135 a complete metric space?

**Proposition 137:** The rationals are not a  $G_\delta$  subset of  $R^1$ .

**Definition 138:** Let  $\#$  denote the first uncountable ordinal, and let  $[1, \#]$  denote the set of all ordinals up to and including  $\#$  (similarly,  $[1, \#)$  denotes those up to but not including  $\#$ ). For every pair of ordinals  $a$  and  $b$  ( $a < b$ ) in  $(1, \#)$ , the segment  $(a, b) = \{x : a < x < b\}$  and the sets  $[1, a)$  and  $(a, \#]$  are neighborhoods.

**Proposition 139:** If  $C$  is a collection of neighborhoods that cover  $[1, \#)$ , then there exists  $x < \#$  such that  $\cup\{G \in C : x \in G\}$  covers  $[x, \#)$ .

**Proposition 140:** Suppose  $f$  is map of  $[1, \#)$  into  $R^1$ . Then a point  $x$  of  $[1, \#)$  and a real number  $r$  exist such that  $f[[x, \#)) = r$ .

**Proposition 141:**  $[1, \#)$  and  $[1, \#]$  are normal.

**Proposition 142:**  $[1, \#]$  is metrizable.

**Proposition 143:**  $[1, \#)$  is metrizable.

**Proposition 144:**  $[1, \#]$  is bicomact.

**Definition 145:** A metric space  $S$  is **complete** if there exists a metric  $k$  for  $S$  such that  $(S, k)$  is complete.

**Proposition 146:**  $[1, \#)$  is bicomact.

**Proposition 147:** Every infinite subset of  $[1, \#)$  has a limit point.

**Proposition 148:** The product of countably many metric spaces is metrizable.

**Proposition 149:** The product obtained by crossing  $[0, 1]$  with itself countably many times is metrizable.

**Proposition 150:** Proposition 148 is true if the word “countable” is replaced by the word “uncountable”.

**Proposition 151:** Every regular second countable Hausdorff space is metrizable.